

Facilitator guide — Visualizations & Interpretation

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About these activities

These activities teach participants to **read a chart and say what it means** — first manually, then with the AI, ending in a real apply activity on country data. They deliberately pair a "do it yourself" path with an "AI does it, you verify" path, for both building charts and writing interpretations.

Six handouts. ~100 min of participant time.

How to run it

- Start with the **reading framework** (handout 1) — it is the reference everything else builds on.
- The sequence pairs **a full manual pass** (handouts 2 + 3) with **a full AI pass** (handouts 4 + 5), so participants complete the whole build-and-interpret loop themselves before they see the AI do it.
- For each platform task, **demo it first**, then let participants follow the handout. The handout re-explains what you showed.
- The through-line: the AI is fast, but the participant is accountable. Reinforce verification every time the AI appears.

The activities

1. How to read a FASTR visualization

Reference · ~10 min

What it is — a reusable reference: a six-step framework for reading any chart.

What the handout covers — the six steps (indicator, level/period, comparison, values, what stands out, so-what), how to choose chart types, and practice on an existing deck with a teammate.

Watch for — misreading the y-axis is the single most common mistake. Remind participants to check the legend, axes and footnotes *before* interpreting.

2. Create your first visualization

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity building a time-series chart manually via the setup panel.

What the handout covers — + New visualization, pick indicator / period / chart type / level, save with a clear name to their folder, then repeat for two more indicators.

Watch for — participants default to one chart type. Reinforce: **line** charts for trends over time, **bar** charts for comparing places.

3. Write an interpretation for a chart

Activity · ~20 min

What it is — a writing activity teaching the three-part interpretation structure for a slide.

What the handout covers — a message-carrying title, a facts-only "what you see", and an action-oriented "what it means", added alongside a chart on a slide.

Watch for — titles that merely describe ("Coverage results"), facts mixed with interpretation, and vague so-whats that name no person or next step.

4. Build a visualization with the AI Assistant

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity producing the same chart via plain-language AI requests.

What the handout covers — type a chart request, review whether the AI matched the ask (indicator, period, adjusted vs raw), iterate in short turns, and save.

Watch for — participants trust the first answer. They must verify indicator, period, chart type — and especially **adjusted vs raw data** — before saving.

5. Let the AI draft the interpretation

Activity · ~15 min

What it is — a hands-on activity using the AI to draft interpretation text, then verifying it.

What the handout covers — prompt the AI for an interpretation, verify each claim against the chart, refine in plain language, and add local context the AI cannot know.

Watch for — trusting confident-sounding AI text. Every claim must be checked against the chart, and the recommended action must be owned by the participant.

6. Apply — spot a disruption

Activity · ~25 min

What it is — a capstone apply activity using real country data to identify a disruption and write a finding.

What the handout covers — country teams pick a flagged indicator, open its disruption chart, work the six-step framework, add local context, write a three-part finding, and share it with the room.

Watch for — a disruption is rarely a single-month dip. Steer teams toward sustained drops (3+ months); remind them that stable volumes can still mean falling coverage if population is growing.

Wrapping up

Activity 6 is the proof these activities worked: a team that can pick a real disruption and state it clearly has the core FASTR skill. Use the share-back to surface and correct weak findings.